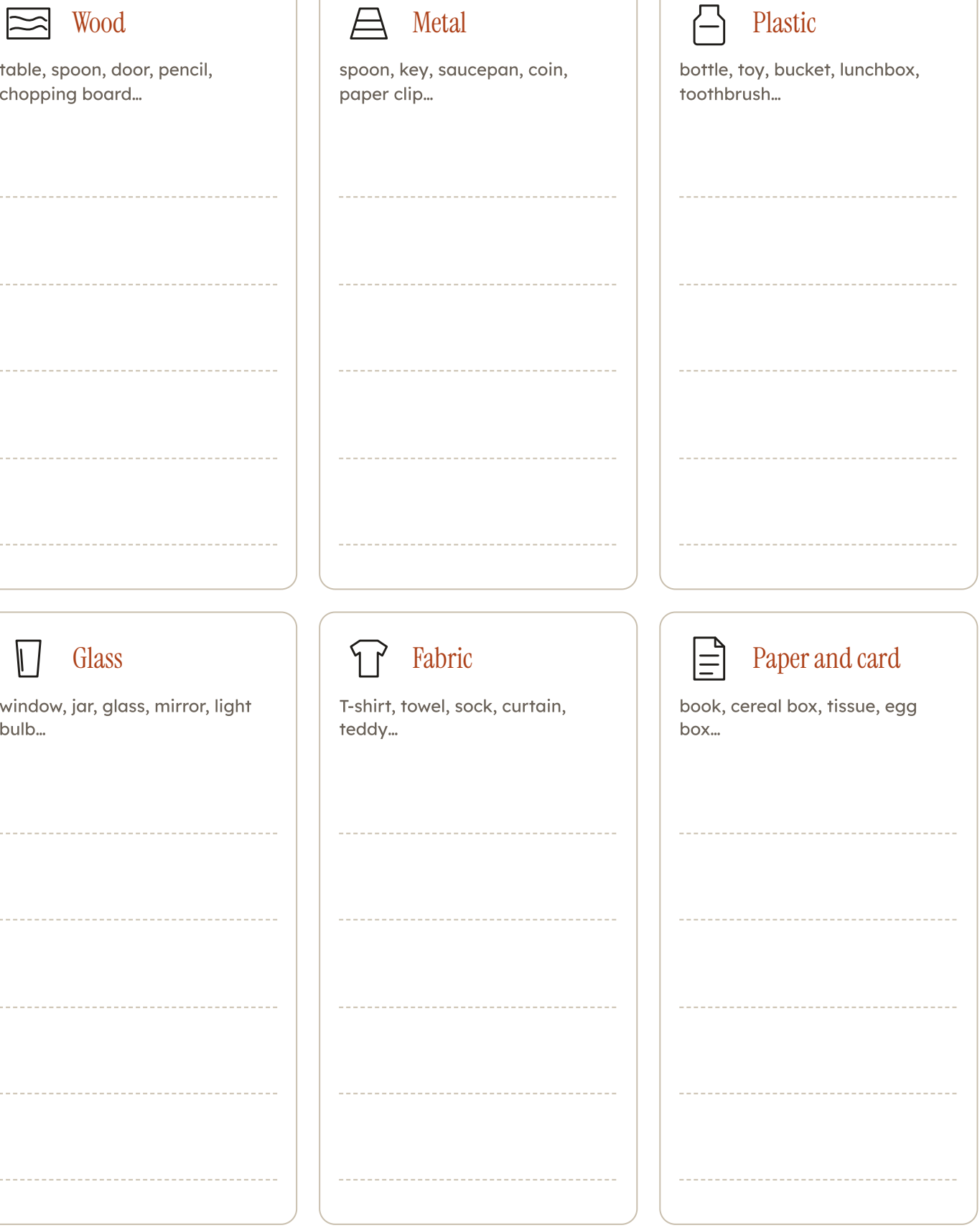
Material hunt: my sorting chart

10 POINTS

Go round your home like a detective. Find things made of each material and write (or draw) them in the right box. Some things are made of more than one material: choose the main one.



Wood

table, spoon, door, pencil, chopping board…

Metal

spoon, key, saucepan, coin, paper clip…

Plastic

bottle, toy, bucket, lunchbox, toothbrush…

Glass

window, jar, glass, mirror, light bulb…

Fabric

T-shirt, towel, sock, curtain, teddy…

Paper and card

book, cereal box, tissue, egg box…

Name _____ Date _____

What is it like? Test it!

10 POINTS

Choose eight things from your hunt. Test each one and tick every box that is true.

Hard? Press it with your thumb. Does it squash?

Bendy? Bend it a little. Does it bend or stay stiff?

Shiny? Shine a torch on it. Does it gleam?

See-through? Hold it up. Can you see through it?

Waterproof? Drip one drop of water. Does it soak in?

Magnetic? Touch it with a fridge magnet. Does it stick?

Thing	Material	△ hard	⌒ bendy	☼ shiny	▭ see-through	💧 waterproof	🧲 magnetic

I noticed…

Which material was the only magnetic one? Which things were see-through? Why is a window made of glass and not wood?

Name _____ Date _____

Victorian materials, modern materials

10 POINTS

Victorian homes had almost no plastic. Things were made of wood, iron, tin, glass, pottery, leather, wool and cotton. For each pair, tick what the Victorian one was made of and what yours is made of.

Tin bath
filled with kettles by the fire

then · now

Bath
plumbed in, hot tap

then [metal] now [plastic] [metal] [other]

Wooden hoop and stick
a favourite toy

then · now

Hula hoop

then [wood] now [plastic] [wood] [other]

Slate and slate pencil
wiped clean with a rag

then · now

Whiteboard and pen

then [rock] now [plastic] [metal] [other]

Candle and gas lamp
flames for light

then · now

Light bulb and switch

then [wax] [metal] now [glass] [plastic]

Rag doll or peg doll
sewn at home

then · now

My favourite toy

then [fabric] [wood] now [plastic] [other]

Glass milk bottle, paper bag
brought by a milk cart

then · now

Milk bottle, carrier bag

then [glass] [paper] now [plastic] [card]

Did you know?

One of the very first man-made plastics was shown in Victorian times: Alexander Parkes showed "Parkesine" at a big exhibition in London in 1862. It was rare, so Victorian children hardly ever saw any plastic. Bakelite, the first plastic everyone used, came in 1907, six years after Victoria died.



A Victorian cast-iron kitchen range · David Dixon, 2015, CC BY-SA 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Name _____ Date _____